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English Vocabulary

PUBLICATION METADATA

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BOOK HIGHLIGHTS & LEARNING FEATURES

- ' Structured 14-Section Comprehensive Mastery Layout
- ' Visual Memory Cards, Mnemonics & Sound Associations
- ' Exam Trend Analysis, PYQ Notes & Shortcut Formulas
- ' High-Retention Active Recall & Common Mistake Alerts
- ' Quick Revision Summary & One-Page Exam Formula Sheet

Ø<β⁻ EXAM TREND & FOCUS

◊ EXAM FOCUS: One-Word Substitutions (OWS) constitute a substantial portion of the English Language section in major competitive exams. In SSC CGL/CHSL, OWS questions account for 3 to 5 direct questions (6–10 marks), while in Banking, State PSCs, and UPSC (CDS/NDA), they are frequently tested through Cloze Tests, Synonyms/Antonyms, and Sentence Completion.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will master:

- Etymological Analysis: How to deconstruct unfamiliar words using Greek and Latin roots.
- Contextual Semantic Mapping: Understanding the precise nuance of highly confused vocabulary pairs.
- Active Recall & Retrieval: Memorizing 50+ high-yield words (focusing on the A-E alphabet spectrum) through advanced mnemonic devices.
- Exam Elimination Tactics: Eliminating incorrect options systematically using prefix-suffix tracking.

Quick Overview & Chapter Roadmap

This chapter focuses on a critical subset of vocabulary: Words Denoting Persons, Beliefs, and Human Behaviors. These are the most frequently targeted domains in competitive exams because their meanings often overlap, creating classic traps for aspirants.

Rather than presenting a dry, alphabetical list for rote memorization, this guide approaches vocabulary through Morphological Architecture—breaking words down into Root, Prefix, and Suffix.

[MORPHOLOGICAL ARCHITECTURE OF VOCABULARY]

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[illegible] $\frac{0}{0}\frac{1}{4}$ $\frac{0}{0}\frac{1}{4}$ $\frac{0}{0}\frac{1}{4}$

[Prefix] [Root] [Suffix]

	(Modifies Meaning)	(Core Semantic)	(Grammatical/
1. Lexical	- Lexical Nouns: <i>cat, dog, tree</i> - Lexical Verbs: <i>run, jump, sleep</i> - Lexical Adjectives: <i>big, small, happy</i> - Lexical Adverbs: <i>quickly, slowly, often</i> - Lexical Prepositions: <i>under, over, between</i> - Lexical Conjunctions: <i>and, but, or</i> - Lexical Interjections: <i>oh, wow, hey</i> - Lexical Particles: <i>well, then, yes</i>	- Core Nouns: <i>cat, dog, tree</i> - Core Verbs: <i>run, jump, sleep</i> - Core Adjectives: <i>big, small, happy</i> - Core Adverbs: <i>quickly, slowly, often</i> - Core Prepositions: <i>under, over, between</i> - Core Conjunctions: <i>and, but, or</i> - Core Interjections: <i>oh, wow, hey</i> - Core Particles: <i>well, then, yes</i>	- Grammatical Nouns: <i>the, a, this, that</i> - Grammatical Verbs: <i>is, are, was, were</i> - Grammatical Adjectives: <i>very, more, less</i> - Grammatical Adverbs: <i>very, more, less</i> - Grammatical Prepositions: <i>in, on, at</i> - Grammatical Conjunctions: <i>if, when, because</i> - Grammatical Interjections: <i>um, uh, er</i> - Grammatical Particles: <i>so, too, either</i>

e.g., An- (Without) e.g., Theo (God) Behavioral Agent)

e.g., -ist (Doer)

Main Concepts & Formulas

The Anatomy of Word Construction

Most high-yield vocabulary words are built like compound formulas. If you know the value of the variables (Roots/Prefixes/Suffixes), you can calculate the meaning of almost any unknown word.

Word = Prefix (Direction/Tone) + Root (Core Concept) + Suffix (Agent/State)

Key Morphological Elements

Prefix / Root / Suffix	Semantic Meaning	Exemplar Word	Deconstruction
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An- / A- (Prefix)	Without, Lacking, Negation	Atheist	A- (without) + Theos (God) = One who lacks belief in God.
Theo- / Theism (Root)	God, Religion	Monotheist	Mono- (one) + Theos (God) = Believer in one God.
Biblio- (Root)	Book	Bibliophile	Biblio- (book) + Phile (lover) = A book lover.
Phile (Suffix)	Lover, Enthusiast	Philanthropist	Phil- (love) + Anthropos (mankind) = Lover of humanity.
Demos (Root)	People, Population	Demagogue	Demos (people) + Agogos (leader/manipulator) = Leader of people.
ist (Suffix)	Denotes a person who practices/believes	Egotist	Ego (self) + -ist (practitioner) = Self-centered person.

+P IMPORTANT POINT

+P IMPORTANT: Suffixes are highly reliable indicators of grammatical category and semantic intent:

KEY NOTE

ist: Agent noun (the person who does). E.g., Atheist, Anarchist*.

KEY NOTE

er / -eur: Specialist or practitioner. E.g., Connoisseur*.

KEY NOTE

phile: Enthusiast or lover. E.g., Bibliophile*.

KEY NOTE

ate: One who undergoes or performs an action. E.g., Apostate*.

Detailed Explanations & Theory

Here, we present an exhaustive, analyzed breakdown of the critical, exam-targeted words from the A-E spectrum, classified by thematic groups.

Category A: Words Related to Belief, Religion, and Philosophy

Atheist (noun)

- Etymology: Greek a- (without) + theos (god) + suffix -ist* (believer/agent).
- Definition: A person who disbelieves or lacks belief in the existence of God or gods.
- Synonyms: Infidel, Non-believer, Skeptic.
- Antonyms: Theist, Believer, Devotee.
- Contextual Nuance: An atheist asserts that God does not exist, whereas an agnostic* claims that the existence of God is unknown or unknowable.

Apostate (noun)

- Etymology: Greek apo (away, off, apart) + stasis* (standing, position). Literally, "standing away" or "one who stands apart."
- Definition: A person who deserts or renounces a religious belief, political party, principle, or cause.

- Synonyms: Renegade, Defector, Turncoat, Traitor.
- Antonyms: Loyalist, Disciple, Adherent.
- Contextual Nuance: Usually implies a public or dramatic abandonment of a deeply held, formal allegiance.

Ascetic (noun / adjective)

- Etymology: Greek asketes (monk, hermit), from askein* (to exercise, train as an athlete).
- Definition: A person who practices extreme self-denial and abstains from normal physical pleasures, often for spiritual or religious reasons.
- Synonyms: Hermit, Recluse, Anchorite, Austere.
- Antonyms: Hedonist, Sybarite, Voluptuary.
- Contextual Nuance: Focuses on rigorous self-discipline and avoidance of indulgence, as opposed to a sybarite*, who lives solely for physical luxury.

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Category B: Words Related to Social Order, Law, and Politics

Anarchist (noun)

- Etymology: Greek an- (without) + arkhos (ruler/authority) + suffix -ist*.
- Definition: A person who rebels against any established authority, ruling power, or state system, believing that all forms of government are undesirable.
- Synonyms: Rebel, Insurgent, Nihilist, Iconoclast.
- Antonyms: Loyalist, Conformist, Authoritarian.

Arbitrator (noun)

- Etymology: Latin arbitratus (judgment), from arbitrari* (to judge/decide).
- Definition: An independent, neutral person or body officially appointed or chosen to settle a dispute between conflicting parties.
- Synonyms: Mediator, Referee, Umpire, Intermediary.
- Antonyms: Disputant, Litigant, Contender.
- Contextual Nuance: An arbitrator's decision is typically legally binding, whereas a mediator* simply helps parties reach their own compromise.

Demagogue (noun)

- Etymology: Greek demos (people) + agogos* (leader, guider, driver).
- Definition: A political leader who seeks support by appealing to popular desires, passions, and prejudices of the common people rather than by using rational argument.
- Synonyms: Rabble-rouser, Agitator, Firebrand.
- Contextual Nuance: Carrying a highly negative connotation, a demagogue* manipulates public emotion for personal power.

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Category C: Words Related to Art, Taste, and Luxury

Connoisseur (noun)

- Etymology: Old French connoisseur, from connoistre (to know). Derived from Latin cognoscere* (to thoroughly know).
- Definition: An expert judge in matters of taste, fine arts, food, wine, or music.
- Synonyms: Expert, Virtuoso, Cognoscenti, Gourmet.
- Antonyms: Amateur, Neophyte, Tyro, Novice.
- Spelling Trap: Frequently tested in spelling error sections. Note the double n, double s, and the oi combination (C-O-N-N-O-I-S-S-E-U-R*).

Dilettante (noun / adjective)

- Etymology: Italian dilettare (to delight), from Latin delectare*.
- Definition: A person who cultivates an area of interest, such as the fine arts, in a superficial, casual way without real commitment, expertise, or deep knowledge.
- Synonyms: Amateur, Dabbler, Tyro, Non-professional.
- Antonyms: Professional, Expert, Connoisseur.
- Contextual Nuance: A dilettante plays with arts for amusement; a connoisseur* possesses authentic, structured knowledge.

Epicure (noun)

- Etymology: Derived from the Greek philosopher Epicurus*, whose philosophy was often misconstrued as advocating sensory indulgence.
- Definition: A person who takes particular pleasure in fine food and drink.
- Synonyms: Gourmet, Gastronome, Voluptuary.
- Contextual Nuance: While an epicure seeks high-quality refinement in culinary delights, a glutton* eats excessively and indiscriminately.

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Category D: Words Related to Social Identity, Behavior, and self-Concept**Bigot (noun)**

- Etymology: Old French term of obscure origin, historically used as a derogatory term for superstitious or prejudiced people.
- Definition: A person who is obstinately, unreasonably, and intolerantly attached to a belief, opinion, or political faction, especially one who is prejudiced against members of outgroups.
- Synonyms: Fanatic, Dogmatist, Sectarian, Zealot.
- Antonyms: Moderate, Liberal, Tolerant.

Bibliophile (noun)

- Etymology: Greek biblion (book) + philos* (loving/dear).
- Definition: A person who collects, loves, or has a great passion for books.
- Synonyms: Bookworm, Book-lover, Bibliolater.
- Antonyms: Bibliophobe (one who fears/hates books).

Chauvinist (noun / adjective)

- Etymology: Named after Nicolas Chauvin*, a soldier of the French First Republic who was fanatically devoted to Napoleon.
- Definition: A person who is aggressively, blindly, and intolerantly patriotic, or who has a prejudiced, unreasoning belief in the superiority of their own group, nation, or gender.
- Synonyms: Zealot, Jingoist, Sectarian, Bigot.
- Contextual Nuance: Often used in modern contexts as "male chauvinist"—one who believes in the inherent superiority of men over women.

Cosmopolitan (noun / adjective)

- Etymology: Greek kosmos (world) + polis* (city/citizen). Literally, "a citizen of the world."
- Definition: A person who regards the whole world as their country and is free from local or national prejudices.
- Synonyms: Universal, Global, Ecumenical, Sophisticated.
- Antonyms: Provincial, Parochial, Insular.

Egotist (noun)

- Etymology: Latin ego (I, self) + intrusive t (phonetic bridge) + -ist*.
- Definition: An arrogantly self-centered person who talks excessively about themselves and their own achievements.
- Synonyms: Narcissist, Braggart, Self-seeker.
- Antonyms: Altruist, Selfless person.
- Key Distinction: See "Common Mistakes" for the critical difference between Egoist and Egotist*.

Emigrant (noun)

- Etymology: Latin e- (out of) + migrare* (to move/shift).
- Definition: A person who leaves their own country to settle permanently in another.
- Synonyms: Expatriate, Out-migrant, Exile.
- Antonyms: Immigrant (one who enters a country).

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Category E: Words Related to Lifespan, Time, and Miscellaneous Trends

Centenarian (noun / adjective)

- Etymology: Latin centum (one hundred) + annus* (year).
- Definition: A person who is one hundred years old or older.
- Related terms: Nonagenarian (90-99 years old), Octogenarian (80-89 years old), Septuagenarian (70-79 years old).

Cynosure (noun)

- Etymology: Greek kunosoura* (dog's tail), which was the ancient Greek name for the constellation Ursa Minor containing the Polaris (the North Star), used by sailors for navigation.
- Definition: A person or thing that is the center of attention, admiration, or guidance.
- Synonyms: Focal point, Cynosure, Star, Magnet.

Ephemeral (adjective)

- Etymology: Greek ephemeros (lasting only a day), from epi (upon) + hemera* (day).
- Definition: Lasting or existing for a very short, fleeting period.
- Synonyms: Transient, Transitory, Fleeting, Evanescent, Fugitive.
- Antonyms: Eternal, Perpetual, Permanent, Perennial.

Bankrupt / Insolvent (noun / adjective)

- Etymology: Italian banca rotta (broken bench). Ancient traders had their trade tables broken when they defaulted. Latin in- (not) + solvere* (to free/pay).
- Definition: A person or organization declared by law as unable to pay their outstanding debts.
- Synonyms: Bankrupt, Ruined, Pauperized.
- Antonyms: Solvent, Wealthy, Affluent.

Epidemic (noun / adjective)

- Etymology: Greek epi (among/upon) + demos* (people).
- Definition: A widespread occurrence of an infectious disease in a community or geographic area at a particular time.
- Nuance Scale: Endemic (local/native) \to Epidemic (regional outbreak) \to Pandemic (global outbreak).

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Worked Examples & Applications

Let us observe how these words are tested under different exam patterns.

Type A: Direct Definition Matching

KEY NOTE

Ø=ÜÖ EXAMPLE 1 (SSC CGL Archetype):

KEY NOTE

Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words:

KEY NOTE

"A person who deserts their religion, cause, or political faction."

KEY NOTE

(a) Ascetic

KEY NOTE

(b) Apostate

KEY NOTE

(c) Chauvinist

KEY NOTE

(d) Dilettante

KEY NOTE**KEY NOTE**

Answer: (b) Apostate

KEY NOTE

Explanation: Deconstruct the options: Ascetic is a self-denying hermit; Chauvinist is a fanatical patriot; Dilettante is an amateur art-dabbler. Thus, Apostate (one who stands away) is the perfect fit.

Type B: Contextual Sentence Fillers**KEY NOTE**

Ø=ÜÖ EXAMPLE 2 (Banking/UPSC Archetype):

KEY NOTE

Choose the correct option to fill in the blank:

KEY NOTE

"The art gallery was crowded with superficial _____ who knew the names of the painters but had no authentic understanding of the creative process."

KEY NOTE

(a) Connoisseurs

KEY NOTE

(b) Demagogues

KEY NOTE

(c) Dilettantes

KEY NOTE

(d) Centenarians

KEY NOTE**KEY NOTE**

Answer: (c) Dilettantes

KEY NOTE

Explanation: The key clue is "superficial" and "no authentic understanding". This directly points to dilettantes (dabblers). Connoisseurs is incorrect because they possess deep, expert knowledge.

Type C: Synonyms & Antonyms (Matching Context)**KEY NOTE**

EXAMPLE 3 (State PSC Archetype):

KEY NOTE

What is the antonym of the word 'Ephemeral'?

KEY NOTE

(a) Transient

KEY NOTE

(b) Perpetual

KEY NOTE

(c) Transitory

KEY NOTE

(d) Fleeting

KEY NOTE**KEY NOTE**

Answer: (b) Perpetual

KEY NOTE

Explanation: Ephemeral means lasting for a very short time. Options (a), (c), and (d) are direct synonyms. Only Perpetual (eternal/long-lasting) represents the opposite semantic value.

PYQ Discussion & Exam Trends**Analysis of the Last 5 Years (SSC CGL/CHSL, IBPS PO, State PSC)**

An analysis of past papers reveals clear trends in vocabulary testing:

[HIGH-FREQUENCY VOCABULARY THEMES]

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[Behavioral Traps] [Expertise / Art] [Faith / Religion]

(Egotist, Bigot, Chauvinist) (Connoisseur, Dilettante, Epicure) (Atheist, Apostate, Ascetic)

40% Weightage 35% Weightage 25% Weightage

Ø<β⁻ EXAM TREND & FOCUS

Ø=Ý% PREVIOUS YEAR TREND:

KEY NOTE

The "Double Consonant" Spelling Trap: Words like Connoisseur and Dilettante* are repeatedly featured in the "Spelling Error" sections of SSC CGL Mains and Banking exams.

KEY NOTE

Contextual Shift of "Chauvinist": Earlier exams defined Chauvinist* purely in nationalistic terms (blind patriotism). Modern papers increasingly use it to denote gender bias ("male chauvinist"), testing whether candidates understand evolving usage.

KEY NOTE

The Transient Trilogy: The synonyms Ephemeral, Transient, and Transitory* are highly favored by examiners to check vocabulary depth in antonym questions.

Shortcuts & Exam Tricks

When facing a challenging vocabulary question in the exam room under intense time pressure, employ these strategic shortcuts:

Suffix Elimination Trick (The Agent Filter)

If the question asks for a "person who..." look for agent suffixes:

Agent Suffixes \to -ist, -er, -eur, -phile, -ate

If the options contain words ending in -ism (belief system) or -ity (state of being), eliminate them instantly.

- Example: A person who loves books \to Options: (a) Bibliophilism, (b) Bibliophile. Eliminate (a) immediately because -ism* is the state of belief, not the person.

Tone-Matching Formula (Polarity Analysis)

Determine if the sentence or description requires a positive, neutral, or negative personality.

Tone Mapping: $\begin{cases} \text{Positive} \rightarrow \text{Connoisseur, Bibliophile, Arbitrator} \\ \text{Neutral} \rightarrow \text{Centenarian, Cosmopolitan, Emigrant} \\ \text{Negative} \rightarrow \text{Bigot, Chauvinist, Egotist, Demagogue} \end{cases}$

& EXAM SHORTCUT

&_ SHORTCUT: If the sentence reads: "The politician used aggressive and divisive speeches to win votes, proving himself to be a _____."

KEY NOTE

The context is highly negative. If your options are: (a) Arbitrator (Neutral), (b) Cosmopolitan (Positive), (c) Connoisseur (Positive), and (d) Demagogue (Negative) \to Select (d) immediately without overthinking.

Memory Tricks & Mnemonics

Etymological Tree Construction

Instead of memorizing separate entries, anchor them to a central root system in your mind:

[Root: PHIL (Love)]

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[illegible] $0\frac{1}{4}$ $0/0^{1/4}$

[BIBLIOPHILE]

[PHILANTHROPIST]

Biblio (Book) + Phil

Philan (Humans) + Phil

= Lover of Books

= Lover of Mankind

[Root: DEMOS (People)]

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[illegible] $0\frac{1}{4}$ $0/0^{1/4}$

[DEMAGOGUE]

[EPIDEMIC]

Demos (People) + Agogos (Leader) Epi (Upon) + Demos (People)

= Manipulative Leader

= Disease spreading on people

Common Mistakes to Avoid

Ø=P Lexical Trap 1: Egoist vs. Egotist

- Egoist: A person focused on self-interest and personal advancement. They evaluate everything based on "What is in it for me?" (Concept-driven).
- Egotist: A braggish person who talks incessantly about themselves, their achievements, and their greatness. (Behavior/Talk-driven).

Ø=Ü; SMART TRICK

Ø>Yà MEMORY TRICK: The letter 'T' in egoTist stands for Talk/Tongue. An egoTist talks about himself non-stop. An egoist just quietly acts in self-interest.

Ø=P Lexical Trap 2: Emigrant vs. Immigrant

- Emigrant: A person who moves out of their country.
- Immigrant: A person who moves into a new country.

Ø=Ü SMART TRICK

Ø>Ýà MEMORY TRICK: Use phonetic association:

KEY NOTE

Emigrant \to Exit (leaves a country).

KEY NOTE

Immigrant \to In (enters a country).

Ø=P Lexical Trap 3: Atheist vs. Agnostic

- Atheist: Firmly believes and asserts that God does not exist (A-theos = No God).
- Agnostic: Believes that nothing is known, or can be known, about the existence of God. They are suspended in doubt (A-gnosis = No knowledge).

Ø=P Lexical Trap 4: Epicure vs. Glutton

- Epicure: A refined gourmet who prioritizes the aesthetic quality of food and drink.
- Glutton: A person who consumes vast, excessive quantities of food without regard to quality.

Summary & Key Takeaways

- Prefixes are directional compasses: A-/An- negates, E- means exit, Im-* means into.
- Suffixes define the grammatical agent: -ist, -eur, -phile* refer to individuals practicing behaviors or holding beliefs.
- Precision is paramount: Do not confuse Egoist (selfish) with Egotist (talkative braggart), or Epicure (gourmet) with Glutton* (over-eater).
- Contextual cues are your best friend: Always use polarity analysis (positive vs. negative) to eliminate 50% of the choices instantly in OWS questions.

Practice Questions with Solutions

Directions (Q1 - Q15): Select the most appropriate option that substitutes the given group of words.

Q1. A person who is aggressively and blindly patriotic.

- (a) Demagogue
- (b) Arbitrator
- (c) Chauvinist
- (d) Apostate

Q2. An expert judge in matters of taste, fine arts, food, and wine.

- (a) Connoisseur
- (b) Dilettante

- (c) Epicure
- (d) Bibliophile

Q3. A person who deserts their religion, cause, or political party.

- (a) Ascetic
- (b) Atheist
- (c) Apostate
- (d) Anarchist

Q4. A political leader who manipulates the prejudices and emotions of the common people to gain power.

- (a) Bigot
- (b) Demagogue
- (c) Cynosure
- (d) Egotist

Q5. A person who dabbles in art, literature, or music superficially without serious commitment.

- (a) Connoisseur
- (b) Dilettante
- (c) Ascetic
- (d) Chauvinist

Q6. A person who leaves their own country to settle permanently in another.

- (a) Immigrant
- (b) Emigrant
- (c) Cosmopolitan
- (d) Exile

Q7. Lasting or existing for a very short, fleeting period.

- (a) Perennial
- (b) Centenarian
- (c) Ephemeral
- (d) Ecumenical

Q8. A person who leads a simple life and abstains from physical pleasures for religious reasons.

- (a) Ascetic
- (b) Atheist
- (c) Epicure
- (d) Egotist

Q9. A person who has an obstinate and unreasonable attachment to a belief, opinion, or faction, and is intolerant of others.

- (a) Cosmopolitan
- (b) Bigot
- (c) Arbitrator
- (d) Cynosure

Q10. A person or thing that is the center of attention or admiration.

- (a) Demagogue
- (b) Anarchist

- (c) Cynosure
- (d) Centenarian

Q11. A person who loves or collects books.

- (a) Bibliophile
- (b) Connoisseur
- (c) Ascetic
- (d) Dilettante

Q12. A person who is declared by law as unable to pay his debts.

- (a) Bigot
- (b) Chauvinist
- (c) Bankrupt
- (d) Apostate

Q13. A person who talks excessively about themselves and their achievements.

- (a) Egoist
- (b) Egotist
- (c) Demagogue
- (d) Arbitrator

Q14. A person who regards the whole world as his country.

- (a) Chauvinist
- (b) Cosmopolitan
- (c) Emigrant
- (d) Atheist

Q15. An independent person officially appointed to settle a dispute.

- (a) Demagogue
- (b) Arbitrator
- (c) Anarchist
- (d) Bigot

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Directions (Q16 - Q30): Contextual Fill in the Blanks. Select the most appropriate vocabulary word to complete the sentence.

Q16. After years of luxury, the tycoon lost his entire fortune and was declared _____ by the court.

- (a) Ascetic
- (b) Insolvent
- (c) Ephemeral
- (d) Cynosure

Q17. The monk lived an _____ life in the remote mountains, eating only wild berries and roots.

- (a) Epicurean
 - (b) Ascetic
 - (c) Egotistical
 - (d) Anarchic
-

Q18. She is a true _____; her home library contains over five thousand rare first-edition novels.

- (a) Dilettante
- (b) Bibliophile
- (c) Demagogue
- (d) Chauvinist

Q19. He is such an intolerable _____; every conversation with him invariably turns into a lecture about his own brilliance.

- (a) Egoist
- (b) Egotist
- (c) Arbitrator
- (d) Cosmopolitan

Q20. The boundary dispute between the two neighboring states was finally referred to a neutral _____ appointed by the Supreme Court.

- (a) Demagogue
- (b) Arbitrator
- (c) Chauvinist
- (d) Bigot

Q21. He is a _____ of classical music; he can identify any Mozart symphony by hearing just a few notes.

- (a) Dilettante
- (b) Connoisseur
- (c) Ascetic
- (d) Atheist

Q22. The protest turned violent when a radical _____ threw a smoke bomb at the police barricades.

- (a) Arbitrator
- (b) Anarchist
- (c) Centenarian
- (d) Cosmopolitan

Q23. The beauty of the morning mist over the lake is _____; it vanishes the moment the sun rises.

- (a) Perpetual
- (b) Ephemeral
- (c) Centenarian
- (d) Chauvinistic

Q24. His _____ views on religion prevent him from listening to any logical argument that contradicts his belief system.

- (a) Cosmopolitan
- (b) Bigoted
- (c) Arbitrary
- (d) Ephemeral

Q25. Standing on the stage under the spotlight, the young violinist was the _____ of all eyes.

- (a) Demagogue
 - (b) Cynosure
-

(c) Dilettante

(d) Apostate

Q26. Having lived and worked in London, Tokyo, New York, and Paris, Julian considered himself a thorough _____.

(a) Chauvinist

(b) Cosmopolitan

(c) Emigrant

(d) Ascetic

Q27. The senator was accused of being a _____ after he made speeches appealing to the racial prejudices of the voters.

(a) Mediator

(b) Demagogue

(c) Connoisseur

(d) Bibliophile

Q28. He left Germany in 1938 and lived in America for the rest of his life, technically making him a German _____.

(a) Immigrant

(b) Emigrant

(c) Nationalist

(d) Recluse

Q29. He is a mere _____ in the field of painting, dabbling with watercolors on weekends but possessing no formal training.

(a) Connoisseur

(b) Dilettante

(c) Epicure

(d) Bigot

Q30. After decades of serving his church faithfully, the priest shocked his congregation by declaring himself an _____.

(a) Ascetic

(b) Apostate

(c) Arbitrator

(d) Epicure

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Solutions with Detailed Explanations

Q1. Answer: (c) Chauvinist

- Explanation: A Chauvinist is blindly and intolerantly devoted to their country or group. A Demagogue is a manipulative leader; an Arbitrator is a dispute-settler; an Apostate* is a religious turncoat.

Q2. Answer: (a) Connoisseur

- Explanation: A Connoisseur has expert taste in art, food, wine, etc. A Dilettante is a superficial dabbler; an Epicure loves fine food but is not necessarily an expert judge across all fine arts; a Bibliophile* is a book lover.

Q3. Answer: (c) Apostate

- Explanation: Apostate is the exact word for someone who deserts their faith or cause. Ascetic means self-denying; Atheist means a non-believer in God; Anarchist* is an anti-government rebel.

Q4. Answer: (b) Demagogue

- Explanation: Demagogue combines demos (people) and agogos (leader/driver), meaning a manipulative political leader. Bigot is a prejudiced fanatic; Cynosure is the center of attention; Egotist* is a self-bragger.

Q5. Answer: (b) Dilettante

- Explanation: A superficial dabbler in art is a Dilettante. A Connoisseur is an expert; an Ascetic is a hermit; a Chauvinist* is a fanatic.

Q6. Answer: (b) Emigrant

- Explanation*: One who leaves their own country to settle elsewhere is an Emigrant (Exit). One who enters a new country is an Immigrant (In).

Q7. Answer: (c) Ephemeral

- Explanation: Ephemeral means lasting for a very short time. Perennial means permanent/eternal; Centenarian means 100 years old; Ecumenical* means universal.

Q8. Answer: (a) Ascetic

- Explanation: An Ascetic leads a life of extreme self-denial for spiritual reasons. An Epicure loves fine dining; an Egotist is self-absorbed; an Atheist* doesn't believe in God.

Q9. Answer: (b) Bigot

- Explanation: A Bigot is intolerant of other people's views or beliefs. Cosmopolitan is a citizen of the world; Arbitrator is a mediator; Cynosure* is the center of attraction.

Q10. Answer: (c) Cynosure

- Explanation: Cynosure means the center of attraction. Demagogue is a rabble-rousing politician; Anarchist is a rebel; Centenarian* is a person aged 100+.

Q11. Answer: (a) Bibliophile

- Explanation: Biblio (book) + phile (lover) = Bibliophile. Connoisseur is an art expert; Ascetic is a hermit; Dilettante* is an amateur.

Q12. Answer: (c) Bankrupt

- Explanation: A person legally unable to pay debts is Bankrupt (or Insolvent). Bigot is an intolerant person; Chauvinist is a fanatic patriot; Apostate* is a turncoat.

Q13. Answer: (b) Egotist

- Explanation: The egoTist talks (Talk) excessively about himself. An egoist simply acts out of self-interest; a Demagogue is a manipulative leader; an Arbitrator* is a judge.

Q14. Answer: (b) Cosmopolitan

- Explanation: Cosmo (world) + polis (citizen) = Cosmopolitan (world citizen). Chauvinist is a blind patriot; Emigrant is an out-migrant; Atheist* is a non-believer.

Q15. Answer: (b) Arbitrator

- Explanation: An Arbitrator is appointed to settle disputes. Demagogue is a political agitator; Anarchist is anti-government; Bigot* is a fanatic.

Q16. Answer: (b) Insolvent

- Explanation: Insolvent* is a synonym for bankrupt, fitting perfectly in the context of losing a fortune and being legally declared unable to pay debts.

Q17. Answer: (b) Ascetic

- Explanation: Eating only berries and living in remote mountains indicates an ascetic* (monk-like/austere) life of self-denial.

Q18. Answer: (b) Bibliophile

- Explanation: Possessing 5,000 rare books indicates a bibliophile* (book lover).

Q19. Answer: (b) Egotist

- Explanation: A person who turns every conversation into a lecture about their own brilliance is an egotist* (braggart).

Q20. Answer: (b) Arbitrator

- Explanation: A neutral party appointed by a court to resolve a boundary dispute is an arbitrator*.

Q21. Answer: (b) Connoisseur

- Explanation: Being able to identify any Mozart symphony shows the deep, structured expertise of a connoisseur*.

Q22. Answer: (b) Anarchist

- Explanation: Throwing smoke bombs at police and causing violent disorder in a protest is typical of an anarchist* (one who rebels against established law and order).

Q23. Answer: (b) Ephemeral

- Explanation: Vanishing quickly indicates that the mist's beauty is ephemeral* (transient/fleeting).

Q24. Answer: (b) Bigoted

- Explanation: Being obstinately and intolerantly attached to one's beliefs, shutting out logical arguments, is the definition of bigoted*.

Q25. Answer: (b) Cynosure

- Explanation: Being under the spotlight and the center of "all eyes" means being the cynosure* (center of attention).

Q26. Answer: (b) Cosmopolitan

- Explanation: Having lived in several major global metropolises and feeling at home anywhere makes Julian a cosmopolitan* (world citizen).

Q27. Answer: (b) Demagogue

- Explanation: A politician appealing to prejudices rather than reason to sway voters is a demagogue*.

Q28. Answer: (b) Emigrant

- Explanation*: He left his homeland (Exit), making him an Emigrant from Germany's perspective.

Q29. Answer: (b) Dilettante

- Explanation: Painting occasionally on weekends without serious commitment or formal training makes him a dilettante* (dabbler).

Q30. Answer: (b) Apostate

- Explanation: A priest formally renouncing his faith or church becomes an apostate*.

Final One-Page Quick Revision Sheet

Word	Part of Speech	Root/Deconstruction	Core Meaning	Synonym	Antonym
Atheist	Noun	A- (without) + theos (god)	Lacks belief in God	Skeptic, Infidel	Theist, Believer
Apostate	Noun	Apo (away) + stasis (stand)	Deserter of a faith/ cause	Renegade, Defector	Loyalist, Adherent

Arbitrator	Noun	Latin arbitrari (to judge)	Neutral dispute settler	Mediator, Referee	Litigant, Disputant
Ascetic	Noun/Adj	Greek asketes (monk)	Spiritual self-denier	Hermit, Austere	Hedonist, Sybarite
Anarchist	Noun	An- (no) + arkhos (ruler)	Anti-government rebel	Nihilist, Insurgent	Conformist, Loyalist
Bankrupt	Noun/Adj	Italian banca rotta (broken bench)	Legally unable to pay debts	Insolvent, Ruined	Solvent, Affluent
Bigot	Noun	Old French (prejudiced)	Intolerant fanatic	Zealot, Dogmatist	Moderate, Tolerant
Bibliophile	Noun	Biblio (book) + phile (lover)	Lover/collector of books	Bookworm	Bibliophobe
Centenarian	Noun/Adj	Centum (100) + annus (year)	100 years old or more	Century-old	Youth, Neophyte
Chauvinist	Noun/Adj	Named after Nicolas Chauvin	Blindly fanatical patriot	Jingoist, Bigot	Cosmopolitan
Connoisseur	Noun	French connoistre (to know)	Expert judge of taste/art	Virtuoso, Specialist	Amateur, Novice
Cosmopolitan	Noun/Adj	Kosmos (world) + polis (city)	Citizen of the world	Sophisticated	Provincial, Insular
Cynosure	Noun	Greek kunosoura (dog's tail/star)	Center of attention	Focal point, Magnet	Nonentity
Demagogue	Noun	Demos (people) + agogos (leader)	Manipulative politician	Rabble-rouser	Statesman
Dilettante	Noun/Adj	Italian dilettare (to delight)	Superficial art dabbler	Amateur, Dabbler	Professional, Expert
Epicure	Noun	From philosopher Epicurus	Lover of fine food/drink	Gourmet, Gastronomer	Glutton
Egotist	Noun	Ego (self) + t (talk) + -ist	Self-centered braggart	Braggart, Narcissist	Altruist, Philanthropist
Emigrant	Noun	E- (out/exit) + migrare (move)	Out-migrant from homeland	Expatriate	Immigrant
Epidemic	Noun/Adj	Epi (upon) + demos (people)	Widespread regional disease	Outbreak, Plague	Endemic, Pandemic
Ephemeral	Adjective	Greek ephemerous (of a day)	Fleeting, short-lived	Transient, Transitory	Eternal, Perpetual

' QUICK REVISION

' FINAL REVISION: To ace OWS questions instantly, read the sentence, identify if the subject is a Person (usually ending in -ist, -er, -phile), identify the Tone (Positive, Negative, Neutral), and map the Root Word (e.g., Biblio = Books, Demos = People, Theos = God).

Ø=B Funny Memory Mode (Visual & Phonetic Mnemonics)

Here are high-efficiency memory cards to lock these words in your permanent memory using sound associations and funny mental images.

Memory Card 1: ANARCHIST

- Word: Anarchist /ˈɒn.ər.kɪst/ (Noun)
- Meaning: A person who wants to destroy all government and established laws.
- Phonetic Sound Connection: Anarchy sounds like "Ann-Nani-Ki-Sist" (An angry elder sister/nani who breaks all household rules).
- Funny Mnemonic Trick: Imagine your sweet grandmother (Nani) suddenly wearing a leather jacket, holding a spray-paint can, and painting graffiti on the walls while shouting, "No more house rules! I am the head now!"* She is the family's ultimate Anarchist!
- Example Sentence: The rebel was arrested for acting as an anarchist, trying to overthrow the local municipal council.*

Memory Card 2: APOSTATE

- Word: Apostate /əˈpɒ.steɪt/ (Noun)
- Meaning: Someone who completely deserts their religion, political party, or principles.
- Phonetic Sound Connection: Apostate sounds like "Opposite-State" or "A-Post-Gate".
- Funny Mnemonic Trick: Picture a politician who climbs up "A Post" near the election "Gate", yells to his party, "I now stand for the exact opposite state of what you believe!"* and jumps down to join the rival team. He changed his entire stance right at the gate!
- Example Sentence: After denouncing his political party's economic policies, he was branded an apostate by his former colleagues.*

Memory Card 3: ASCETIC

- Word: Ascetic /əˈset.ɪk/ (Noun)
- Meaning: Leading a life of extreme self-discipline and avoiding all physical pleasures.
- Phonetic Sound Connection: Ascetic sounds like "Ah-Sestic" or "Acid-Test" / "A-Sceptic".
- Funny Mnemonic Trick: Imagine a man who lives in a bare room, refuses to sit on a soft sofa, and instead sits on an "Acidic" cactus plant because he thinks comfort is a sin. He passes the ultimate "acid-test" of self-denial.
- Example Sentence: The hermit lived an ascetic lifestyle, possessing nothing more than a single bowl and a cotton robe.*

Memory Card 4: BIGOT

- Word: Bigot /ˈbɪɡ.ɪt/ (Noun)
- Meaning: An intolerant person who is unreasonably attached to their own opinions and hates other groups.
- Phonetic Sound Connection: Bigot sounds like "Big-Goat".
- Funny Mnemonic Trick: Imagine a "Big Goat" standing on a narrow bridge. He refuses to let anyone else cross, screaming, "My grass is the only correct grass! Your grass is trash!"* He is just an obstinate, stubborn, narrow-minded Big-Goat (Bigot)!
- Example Sentence: Don't waste your time trying to explain diversity to that bigot; he refuses to respect any culture but his own.*

Memory Card 5: CONNOISSEUR

- Word: Connoisseur /kəˈnɒ.ʃər/ (Noun)
- Meaning: An expert judge in matters of art, taste, food, and wine.
- Phonetic Sound Connection: Connoisseur sounds like "Con-No-Sir" (A clever person who cannot be conned).
- Funny Mnemonic Trick: Imagine a dishonest art dealer trying to sell a fake painting to a sophisticated gentleman. The expert looks through his magnifying glass and says, "You can't Con me, No Sir! I know this is a fake!"* He is a true Con-No-Sir (Connoisseur).

- Example Sentence: As a connoisseur of fine dining, he was invited to rate the new Michelin-star restaurant.*

Ø<ß' Memory Card 6: CYNOSURE

- Word: Cynosure /,ɪˈnɒʃəˈtʃʊr/ (Noun)
- Meaning: The center of attention, attraction, or admiration.
- Phonetic Sound Connection: Cynosure sounds like "Sign-Of-Sure" or "Dinosaur".
- Funny Mnemonic Trick: Imagine walking into a modern corporate office, and there is a giant, friendly Dinosaur wearing a tie sitting at the reception desk. Obviously, the Dinosaur is the absolute Cynosure of the entire building—everyone stops and stares!
- Example Sentence: With her dazzling diamond necklace and elegant red gown, the actress was the cynosure of the evening.*

Ø<ß' Memory Card 7: DEMAGOGUE

- Word: Demagogue /,dɪˈmɑːɡoʊ/ (Noun)
- Meaning: A political leader who wins support by appealing to popular prejudices and emotions.
- Phonetic Sound Connection: Demagogue sounds like "Demo-Gorgon" (like the monster Demogorgon from Stranger Things) or "Dimaag-Ugra" (angry mind/manipulator).
- Funny Mnemonic Trick: Imagine a politician who turns into a scary "Demo-gorgon" monster on stage. Instead of explaining policy, he just roars, makes everyone angry, and manipulates their "Dimaag" (mind) with pure fear. He is a textbook Demagogue!
- Example Sentence: The crowd was easily swayed by the demagogue's fiery speeches, ignoring his lack of concrete plans.*

Ø<ß' Memory Card 8: DILETTANTE

- Word: Dilettante /,dɪˈlɛtənt/ (Noun)
- Meaning: A superficial dabbler in art, literature, or music (an amateur).
- Phonetic Sound Connection: Dilettante sounds like "Daily-Tent" or "Delay-Aunt".
- Funny Mnemonic Trick: Think of your lazy Aunt who pitches a "Daily Tent" in a new art class every day. On Monday she plays guitar, on Tuesday she paints, and on Wednesday she does pottery—but she never practices any of them! She is a lazy Daily-Tent Aunt (Dilettante).
- Example Sentence: She claims to be a classical pianist, but she is merely a dilettante who barely knows the basic scales.*

Ø<ß' Memory Card 9: EPHEMERAL

- Word: Ephemeral /ɪˈfɛmərəl/ (Adjective)
- Meaning: Lasting for a very short, fleeting time.
- Phonetic Sound Connection: Ephemeral sounds like "E-Fever-All" (An electronic viral fever that comes and goes).
- Funny Mnemonic Trick: Think of a viral internet meme. It's like an "E-Fever" that spreads to "All" people on Instagram, but by tomorrow, nobody remembers it. It's completely E-Fever-All (Ephemeral)!
- Example Sentence: Fame on social media is highly ephemeral; one day you are viral, and the next day you are forgotten.*

Ø<ß' Memory Card 10: EGOTIST

- Word: Egotist /ɪˈɡɒtɪst/ (Noun)
- Meaning: A boastful person who talks constantly about themselves.
- Phonetic Sound Connection: Egotist has a "T" for "Talk/Tongue".

- Funny Mnemonic Trick: Imagine a man whose tongue is shaped like the letter "T". Every time he opens his mouth, he can only Talk about his own achievements: "I did this, I did that!"* He has a "T" in his name, so he is an Egotist!
 - Example Sentence: The egotist couldn't stop bragging about his promotion, completely ignoring his team's contribution.*
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